

Project Code:	2025-1-DK01-KA220-VET-000354273					
Action Type:	KA220-VET - Cooperation partnerships in vocational education and training					
Agency:	DK01 - Danish Agency for Higher Education					
Call:	2025	Round:	1	Date:	13-04-2025	

Assessment Sheet

Call for proposals

Name of the Organisation:	MERCANTEC OVRIGE VIRKSOMHEDSFORMER
Title of the proposal:	Sustainable skills in construction
Project Code:	2025-1-DK01-KA220-VET-000354273

I. ASSESSMENT CONCLUSION

Criteria	Score
Relevance	23.0
Quality of the project design and implementation	28.0
Quality of the partnership and cooperation arrangements	18.0
Impact	21.0
Total:	90.0

Comments for the applicant
The project "Sustainable skills in construction" aims to raise awareness on sustainability in construction by fostering a sustainable mindset among VET students and staff, thus transforming technical and social dimensions of sustainability in the construction sector. The fact that the project challenges the traditional focus in VET on technical aspects and knowledge and draws attention to the fact that knowledge in the construction field must be combined with a mindset shift and a change of behavior appears to be innovative. The objectives are highly relevant and interesting and the many products to be developed during the lifetime of the project are scalable to all VET colleges working with construction, and transferable to all VET colleges working with lines of study, where sustainability will become part and parcel of the future work of the students. The project consortium is firmly rooted in the VET sector. The partnership consists of nine VET colleges from six countries including, most of them from the Northern part of Europe. It is convincingly described how not only each partner individually, but the VET sector as such will benefit from the results of the project. Many of the partners have worked together before ensuring a high degree of compliance and progress in the project. The design of the project ensures that the experienced lead of every work package will have a less experienced co-lead. The application is well written with stringent descriptions and arguments, all aspects are fully explained, and it is obvious that the project proposal has been very well prepared and that all partners have been involved in the preparatory process and can be expected to feel ownership of the project. Project objectives are logically linked to the described activities that again are leading logically to the final project products and results that complement each other and form a whole. It makes very good sense that the project is combined with KA1 activities. The different partner organizations represent different expertise in the field and the project application describes how each partner contributes to the final project result and how the competences will be shared. Tasks are clearly distributed. Only one of the project partners is a newcomer and considering the strength and experience of many of the partners, the application could have benefitted from having at least one more newcomer integrated into the partnership. The consortium does not include associated partners. Since three Danish VET schools are involved, one or two Danish construction companies might have been attached as associated partner to ensure involvement of employers' representatives throughout the project and a continuous presence of the employer point of view. It should be mentioned, however, as a very positive aspect, that throughout the descriptions of the WPs, it is evident that all stakeholders – including industry representatives – will be involved. The project would have benefitted by adding a more detailed description of how the partnership would get educational

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authorities involved so that curriculum change can come around. Likewise, a detailed description of how the national and EU networks of the many partners could be activated to disseminate project results.

The project results are very interesting as they focus on the change of mindset that needs to take place so that sustainability will not only be a technical issue of materials. Starting with the workforce of tomorrow makes good sense. The intermediary in this process are the teachers. Therefore, the project focuses on providing teachers with appropriate tools to assist the students in their learning process.

The project skillfully makes an interesting parallel competition to the recognized skills competitions by arranging sustainability skills competitions where the focus is on the mind set – creativity and critical thinking - more than on the hard-core technical skills. The project opens for other colleges to participate in the competitions, if they have KA1 mobilities and can pay their own way.

There are very few places of improvement that should be mentioned, but the project mentions 'the 27-hour-micro-credentials course' many times. However, in the WP description it is mentioned only twice, giving rise to some confusion with the reader.

The project's quality assurance plan is very good and will no doubt ensure thorough documentation of pre-project behavior and past-project behavior among students and teachers that will all be evidence based through the surveys and observations described.

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II. ASSESSMENT

Relevance	Score
The project "Sustainable skills in construction" aims to raise awareness on sustainability in construction by fostering a sustainable mindset among VET students and staff, thus transforming technical and social dimensions of sustainability in the construction sector. Since construction industry, according to the application, plays a significant role in global carbon dioxide emissions, it is obvious that the project addresses the EU Commission priority: Environment and fight against climate change. The project is highly relevant both in its objectives and priorities. The focus on working with sustainability in the building sector is in itself commendable. Working with changing the mindset of teachers and future builders to think much more in terms of sustainability is even more commendable. The application states that whenever there will be student centered activities, they will recruit students with fewer opportunities and have diversity as a focus also. The project has made a set-up for its various activities that will allow for use of green travel for student competitions. As for the needs analysis, the project has carried out a very thorough survey and interview process at all the participating schools and including also building companies to get a thorough impression of the skills gaps, but also of the best practices among the partners. In the section where the applicant is expected to provide information about the needs analysis, there is no mention of the many statistics and EU and industry surveys and reports that are mentioned elsewhere in the application. The application would have benefitted if the paragraph on the needs analysis. The methodology described in the application will surely have the potential to have added value on an EU level. Furthermore, the methodology and the many interesting activities will surely also be able to be transferred to other lines of study, where a sustainability mindset should prevail over a technical sustainability perspective.	23.0
Quality of the project design and implementation	Score
The project proposal has been properly prepared through preparatory visits among partners and interviews with students, teachers/trainers and leaders. Involving all levels in the preparation will most likely improve the options - not only for a meaningful project for all, but also for a successful implementation of the project and for its potential to contribute to the renewal of VET curricula. -- The project objectives are clearly defined, they address the needs identified, and the process towards achieving the goals is described clearly, realistically, and feasibly. Project objectives are logically linked to the described activities that again are leading logically to the final project products and results that complement each other and form a whole. The project has defined a cooperation structure in great detail making sure that appropriate quality control, monitoring and evaluation measures will be handled consistently. The project uses digital tools to a great extent to limit the travel costs and carbon footprint. They also use various digital learning platforms to increase accessibility to various events. The project doesn't mention anything about how they will recognize participation in the various activities for students. WP2 – Need Analysis The project has carried out a very thorough survey and interview process at all the participating schools and including also building companies to get a thorough impression of the skills gaps, but also of the best practices among the partners. In WP2 there is no mention, however, of the many statistics and EU and industry surveys and reports that are mentioned elsewhere in the application. The application would have benefitted if the paragraph on the needs analysis. WP3 – Teaching Sustainable Construction – has many good and highly relevant objectives, where focus is on co-teaching and co-competence initiatives. These initiatives will equip teachers with innovative pedagogical tools and will engage students in hands-on-learning. As in all WPs it is good to see that all stakeholders – including construction companies and consultancies are an integral part ensuring a 360 view of activities. The number and mix of participants in the development process is really good. In the project description there is much mention of the 27-hour-micro-credentials course. This is mentioned only twice by name in WP3, but the descriptions of the activities would seem to indicate, that this is what WP3 is about on the student side. It is described in such a way that the reader must	28.0

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assume that the co-competence Initiative is the same as the micro-credentials. It would have been good if the project application had been as stringent and clear in the description here as it is otherwise.

WP4 – The Friendly Sustainable Skills Competitions (FSSC) is linguistically interesting as the way it phrased; it would mean that the competitions are friendly, which fits in well with the description that focus will be on togetherness rather than technical skills. IF they wanted to link with the content that they want a change of mindset so that future builders would think much more of using sustainably/environmentally friendly materials, the abbreviation should have been SFSC.

The project has planned for the face-to-face student activities – the competitions – to take place geographically spread so that green transport solutions can be used. The project will open for all VET colleges in the EU to take part in the competitions if they have KA1 mobility funding for this. The project application mentions in several places that the partners could use their KA1 mobility grants

for travel. When they describe the competitions, however, it is not mentioned specifically where the funding for the attendance will come from.

The activities and projected results are highly relevant and very interesting. There is also no doubt that the approach will be motivating to students. It is also good to see that they will make it a priority for students with fewer opportunities to participate. Another interesting feature is that the suggested activities – the model, the teachers' manual, the handbook for the sustainability summits – are all scalable and transferable and all involve participation of industry representatives. It is interesting that the VET colleges suggest this sort of alternative skills competition as they are all also very active in the 'real' skills competitions. But it is clever to latch on to the known skills-concept and make it focus on sustainability and the mind set more than showing the real technical skills.

WP5- Dissemination and Impact Very thorough and encompassing and involving all stakeholders. The targets set for dissemination are all good and high, but also realistic.

It would have benefitted the project if they had mentioned the EU wide networks – like EFVET - many of them are members of and which would be an excellent channel for dissemination on an EU level.

Quality of the partnership and cooperation arrangements

Score

The partnership is comprised of nine VET colleges in six countries, most of them from the Northern part of Europe. Except for one newcomer and one less experienced, they all have extensive experience in working with Erasmus+ projects. They complement each other very well in that they each have their area of specialization within building and construction, and they are all working with sustainability. Many of them have worked together before, which will ensure good communication and progress. From a green travel point of view, they are situated in two clusters allowing for students to travel green to the competitions. Also, many steering group members will be able to travel green for meetings.

The partners have all established what would seem to be very competent and experienced project team members.

The partnership has set up the management structure in such a way that there will be an experienced leader and a less experienced co-leader for every WP. Furthermore, the tasks have been distributed according to the expertise of the individual organization. The application describes these special competencies very well.

The partners were all found through a thorough process conducted by the three Danish partners, who travelled to all colleges and conducted interviews, observations and surveys to find the right match and the right foundation for the project.

The consortium does not include associated partners. Since three Danish VET schools are involved, one or two Danish construction companies might have been attached as associated partner to ensure continuous employer point of view.

18.0

Impact

Score

The applicant mentions short-term as well as long-term impact. The project intends to contribute to VET curricula improvement and will prepare very useful tools and frames for VET teachers and leaders to be able to implement curricula changes in practice.

The fact that all levels in the involved organizations as well as external stakeholders are involved and reached through dissemination activities will make it more likely that the goals can be achieved. There is no doubt that the partners will benefit tremendously from participating. There will be

21.0

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capacity building in all organisations as they will have a new way of approaching students and industry and in this process the teachers will be upskilled as well. The teachers and especially the students will benefit by having their minds opened to a different way of looking at sustainable construction. Because the industry is part and parcel of VET education they will also be impacted and directed to looking at sustainable construction not only as technical solutions, but also as a new mindset as how to work with these solutions. The project partners are part of various national and EU wide networks. It would have benefitted the project proposal, if they had included the use of these organisations in the dissemination plan. A stronger formal involvement of employers' representatives throughout the project might have been an extra support for the impact. It is a positive aspect that tools are prepared also in the form of micro-credential and that all tools can be easily assessed and used by others than partners all over Europe.	